



Assignment

Course code: MSJ 4162

Course Title: Environmental Communication

Section: 01

Semester: Spring

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Submission Date: 07/05/2025

The Vulnerable Buriganga

Introduction

The bank of the Buriganga River is considered the focal point in the process of urbanization and modernization in Dhaka. Cottage industries started during the Mughal period, resulting in massive migration and urbanization. Later, more and more factories were placed. And now, it is so unfortunate that most of the riverside areas are covered with tanneries, dyeing factories, plastic products, and other wastes. The matter of concern is that the river has a direct link to the sewerage system of the City Corporation, which is dangerous. Water pollution remains a serious problem for biodiversity and human life.

Target Audience

- **City Corporation:** In Bangladesh, waste volume has doubled every 15 years in the last three decades (Islam, 2021). Dhaka currently manages around 6,500 tons of waste daily, the number is said to increase to 8,500 tons by 2032.
- **Factories Along the river:** There are industries including tanneries, dyeing industries, aluminium, iron and steel workshops, plastic, pharmaceuticals, battery manufacturing, washing, hardware, and cold storage units. Wastes from these industrial installations are still a major contributor to water pollution.
- **Low-income riverside communities:** In Bangladesh, polluting industries and infrastructures are primarily situated in low-income neighborhoods (Mahamud, 2023). More than thousands of poor, migrated rural people working in

textiles, dyeing, leather, and other polluting industries live near the Buriganga River.

Communication Strategy

3.1 Key Message:

“বেঁচে থাক বিড়গঙ্গা, বেঁচে যাক ঢাকা” / “নদীর দেশ বাংলাদেশ, নদী বাঁচলে বাঁচবে দেশ”

Documentary

- **Factory Wastes:** The documentary will show factory wastes and their effects around the Buriganga riverside areas.
- **Households:** People living beside the river will be focused on, too. Their lifestyle, their problems, and their demand will be highlighted.
- **Waste Management System:** The video will contain information about the waste management system in the chosen area.
- **Resistant from Industries:** The video will try to highlight the power structure in the area. It will try to examine the stakeholders, factory owners, policy makers, and influential locals.

4. Script

[Opening – 0:00–0:30]

Visuals: Riverside shots of the Buriganga River (clean to polluted transition) **Narration:**

“ঢাকার প্রাণ বিড়গঙ্গা এখন দূষণের কেন্দ্র”

[Scene 1: Industrial Pollution – 0:30–1:15]

Visuals: Factory drains, workers, chemicals entering the water

Narration:

“নদীত েযন মোছর চাইত প্লাস্টিক েবিশ”

On-screen text:

“দৈনিক ৬৫০০ টন বর্জ্য উ পাদন হয় ঢাকায়.” (*Islam, 2021*)

[Scene 2: Lives at Risk – 1:15–1:45]

Visuals: Low-income riverside homes, families, sick children

Narration:

“স্বাস্থ্য ঝুঁকিতে লক্ষ লক্ষ মানুষ, তবুও যাবার েনই েকোনা জায়গা।.”

[Scene 3: Waste & Power – 1:45–2:30]

Visuals: Overflowing drains, City Corporation trucks, closed factory gates
Narration:

“শহরের পয়ঃনিষ্কাশন সরাসরী নদীত িগেয় িমেশ, কারখানাগুলো মোন না েকোনা
িনিয়ম,
েভোগ মানুষ, দায় েনয় না েকউ!”

[Closing – 2:30–3:00]

Visuals: Community awareness signs, youth cleaning initiatives

Narration:

“Save the river, save the city”

‘বেঁচে থাক বিুডগঙ্া, বেঁচে যাক ঢাকা।’”

End Slide:

“A documentary by Zamiull Haque, Sad Bin Abbas Sanim, & Ahsan Habib.”

References:

Islam, S. (2021). Urban waste management in Bangladesh: An overview with a focus on Dhaka. Asia-Europe Foundation. https://asef.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/11/ASEFSU23-Background-Paper_Waste-Management-in-Bangladesh.pdf

Mahamud, P. (2023). Living in toxicity: Slow violence in the surroundings of the Buriganga River of Bangladesh (Master’s thesis). International Institute of Social Studies, Erasmus University of Rotterdam.

